

Containers technology and Hyper is contributing the runV technology to initiate the project. The Kata Containers community will initially merge both the technologies at their current state to provide light and fast VM based containers

An overview of the project

The Kata Containers project will initially comprise six components, including the agent, runtime, proxy, shim, kernel and packaging of QEMU 2.9. The initial set of projects is essentially based on projects from contributing projects like Clear Containers or runV. It is designed to be architecture agnostic, run on multiple hypervisors and be compatible with the OCI specifications for Docker containers and CRI-O for Kubemetes. For now, Kata will only run on chips based on the x86 architecture and will only support KVM as its hypervisor. The plan is to expand support to other architectures and hypervisors over time.

For users, Kata Containers does not yet provide an installation option directly. Users can either install Clear Containers or runV, since both projects will provide a migration path to Kata Containers at a later date.

The community

Kata Containers is hosted on GitHub under the Apache 2 licence. While it will be managed by the OpenStack Foundation, it is an independent project with its own technical governance and contributor base. The Kata Containers project is governed according to the 'four opens'— open source, open design, open development and open community. Technical decisions will be made by technical contributors and a representative architecture

committee. The community also has a working committee to make non-technical decisions and help influence the project's overall strategy, including marketing, communications, product management and ecosystem support.

Contributing to Kata Containers

Kata Containers is working to build a global, diverse and collaborative community. If you are interested in supporting the technology, you are welcome to participate. There is a requirement for contributors with different expertise and skills, ranging from development, operations, documentation, marketing, community organisation and product management. You can learn more about the project at katacontainers.io, or view the code repositories on GitHub to contribute to the project. You can also talk to fellow contributors on Freenode IRC: #kata-dev or Kata Containers Slack or subscribe to the kata-dev mailing list. 

References

- [1] <https://www.openstack.org/foundation/>
- [2] <https://katacontainers.io/>
- [3] <https://github.com/kata-containers>
- [4] <https://bit.ly/KataSlack>
- [5] <http://lists.katacontainers.io/cgi-bin/mailman/listinfo>

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